

	EMERGENCY MEDICAL SERVICES AGENCY	POLICY NUMBER	740
	A Division of the Merced County Department of Public Health	Effective Date	11/2025
Authority: Health and Safety Code, Division 2.5, and California Code of Regulations, Title 22, Division 9, Chapter 4, 1797.220		Initial Date:	10/2011
		Review Date:	10/2028

DYSTONIC REACTIONS	
Common phenothiazines include: - Chlorpromazine (Thorazine), Metoclopramide (Reglan), Prochlorperazine (Compazine), and Promethazine (Phenergan) A non-phenothiazine medication that can cause dystonic reactions is: - Haloperidol (Haldol) Symptoms might include: - Restlessness, muscle spasms of the neck, jaw, and back, movement of eyeballs (oculogyric crisis), frightened, facial grimace, protruding tongue, or back arching (opisthotonos)	
ADULT	PEDIATRIC
BLS	
Assess Vitals / Obtain SpO ₂ / Oxygen - Titrate to SpO ₂ of 94% or higher / Secure Airway - Assist Ventilations if needed. Check Blood Sugar – If ALOC.	
ALS	
Follow BLS procedures if applicable. Obtain 4-Lead ECG. Vascular Access - IV/IO rate as appropriate.	
Diphenhydramine - 25 mg IV/IO/IM May repeat once after 5 minutes if no response	Diphenhydramine - 1 mg/kg IV/IO/IM, max single dose 25 mg May repeat once after 5 minutes if no response

Signatures on File

Approved By: Tim Williams
EMS Administrator

Ajinder Singh, MD
EMS Medical Director